

This is a Sources Sought Notice (SSN) - a market survey designed to collect written information only. This is not a solicitation announcement for proposals and no contract will be awarded from this announcement. No reimbursement will be made for any costs associated with providing information in response to this announcement or any follow-up information requests. There is no RFQ, or other iteration of a solicitation associated with this Notice, and no telephone calls will be accepted requesting an RFQ package or solicitation. To protect the procurement integrity of any future acquisition that may arise from this announcement, information regarding a government technical point of contact will not be given and no appointments for presentations will be made.

The U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA), Office of Acquisitions and Grants Services (OAGS) issues this Sources Sought announcement on behalf of the FDA's Office of Regulatory Testing and Surveillance (ORTS), to determine the presence of small business sources capable providing bioMérieux consumables for use in instruments manufactured by bioMérieux – specifically, its VIDAS Immunoassay and VITEK Automated Microbiology instrument systems.

The U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) is a regulatory agency with responsibility for the safety of food for humans and animals and the safety and efficacy of drug, devices and other medical products. In support of this regulatory mission, ORTS field laboratories both own and operate BioMérieux VIDAS and VITEK instrument systems which require proprietary reagents, slides, strips and cards. These consumables are used in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations to achieve the goals of screening and identification confirmation of isolates associated with outbreaks. The use of these specific consumables in identifying organisms significantly reduces the time it takes to perform the identification which allows for quicker results and reduced costs to perform these tests.

If your firm is considered a small business source under North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code 334519 - Other Measuring and Controlling Device Manufacturing, Small Business Size Standard of 600 employees, and you believe that your firm would be able to provide the FDA with the instrument consumables or equivalent and compatible domestically-manufactured products described below, please submit by e-mail a capability statement(s) to timothy.walbert@fda.hhs.gov. Other than small business concerns are also encouraged to submit capability statements. An interested supplier shall include information about the company as requested below and demonstrate that it can meet all the following minimum performance requirements.

Background

The Office of Regulatory Testing and Surveillance (ORTS) laboratory network performs scientific testing on products which are regulated by FDA. The BioMérieux instruments are the approved standardized instruments currently in use in FDA laboratories to aid in the screening and identification of micro-organisms isolated from regulatory samples. These instruments use consumable strips, cards, tube media and slides to identify these contaminants in food and environmental samples.

Minimum Technical Requirements are as follows for the specified bioMérieux consumables (or equivalent) for multiple VIDAS and VITEK instrument systems across multiple FDA delivery points:

API 20 E Strips, Catalog #20160

Box shall contain 100 individually wrapped strips and incubation chambers; strips shall include the following biochemical reactions:

- ONPG for beta-galactosidase activity

- Alcohol dehydrogenase
- Lysine decarboxylase
- Ornithine decarboxylase
- Citrate
- Hydrogen Sulfide
- Urea
- Tryptophan decarboxylase
- Indole
- Voges Proskauer
- Gel
- Glucose
- Mannose
- Inositol
- Sorbitol
- Rhamnose
- Saccharose
- Melibiose
- Amygdaline
- Arabinose
- Nitrate reduction
- Nitrogen

API Listeria Strips, Catalog #10300

Box shall contain 10 individually wrapped strips, media vials and incubation chambers; strips shall have the ability to differentiate *Listeria* species using the following biochemical reactions:

- Presence of Arylamidase
- Esculin hydrolysis
- alpha-Mannosidase
- Acidification of
 - D-Arabitol
 - D-Xylose
 - L-Rhamnose
 - Alpha-Methyl-D-glucoside
 - D-Ribose
 - Glucose-1 phosphate
 - D-Tagatose

SX2 Broth 20 Tubes, Catalog #42121

Selective medium inhibiting the growth of organisms except for *Salmonella* species to be screened via VIDAS

VIDAS Strips: Salmonella 60T, Catalog #30702; Listeria 60T, Catalog #30700; VIDAS SET2 (Staph Enterotoxin II, 30TCatalog #30705; QVC VIDAS 60T (Quality Control Test), Catalog #30706

- Test strips shall be compatible with existing VIDAS instrumentation.
- Test strips shall be ready-to-use Solid Phase Receptacle (SPR) coated with antibodies against Salmonella, and Listeria specific antigens
- Test strips shall have a minimum expiration date of at least 6 months
- Each shipment of strips will be of the same lot number
- Assay strips shall contain 10 wells, be foil-sealed and labeled
 - Labels shall contain a barcode that identifies assay code, kit lot number and expiration

- date
- Strip Well 1 shall be empty for sample, control or standard introduction and have perforated foil for ease of sample introduction
- Strip well 2 shall contain 400 µL of prewash solution
- Strip wells 3-5 and 7-9 shall contain 600 µL of wash buffer
- Strip well 6 shall contain 400 µL of conjugate
- Strip well 10 shall contain a cuvette with substrate in which a fluorometric reading can be performed
- Strips shall contain:
 - Assay standard and controls containing purified and inactivated organism specific antigen + preservative + protein stabilizer
 - Assay positive controls
 - Assay specific confidence interval
 - Assay negative control containing TRIS with buffered saline and tween, pH 7.6
 - Specification sheet containing the factory master calibration data required for test calibration on the instrument used for pathogen detection
- Strips shall allow assay interpretation using existing VIDAS automated readers and store all pertinent lot and reagent information within the reader

VITEK 2 Cards: VITEK 2 ANC, Catalog #21347; VITEK 2 BCL, Catalog #21345; VITEK 2 GN, Catalog #21341; VITEK 2 GP, Catalog #21342:

- Cards shall be compatible with existing VITEK 2 instrumentation.
- Cards shall be individually wrapped, with the filling tube
- Cards shall be ready-to-use for the identification of:
 - Gram negative bacteria
 - Gram positive bacteria
 - *Bacillus* species
 - Yeast and yeast-like organisms
 - Anaerobic bacteria
- Cards shall have a minimum expiration date of at least 6 months
- Each shipment of cards will be of the same lot number

VITEK MS Slides and Reagent: VITEK MS DS, Catalog #410893; VITEK MS CHCA, Catalog #411071; VITEK 2 YST, Catalog #21343:

Target slide shall be compatible with existing VITEK MS instrument; reagent must be able to absorb energy and transfer it to micro-organisms to allow ionization for identification.

Contract Type

The Government anticipates a single award (5) year IDIQ contract for proprietary bioMerieux consumables to ensure the FDA/ORTS laboratory program continues to operate without interruption. These items are mission-critical and will be required for the VIDAS and VITEK instrument systems.

Period(s) of Performance

A base period and four option periods are required. Estimated periods of performance are as follows, and are subject to change based on date of award, if any:

Base Year:	6/1/2026 through 5/31/2027
Option Year 1:	6/1/2027 through 5/31/2028
Option Year 2:	6/1/2028 through 5/31/2029
Option Year 3:	6/1/2029 through 5/31/2030
Option Year 4:	6/1/2030 through 5/31/2031

Delivery Points (F.o.b Destination)

Delivery orders under the IDIQ ordering periods shall be shipped to multiple FDA laboratory facilities – all within the contiguous United States.

Responses to this Sources Sought shall unequivocally demonstrate that the respondent is regularly engaged in the sale of same or substantially similar service. Though the target audience is small business vendors or small businesses capable of supplying a U.S. product/service of a small business supplier or producer, all interested parties may respond in the form of a capabilities statement. At a minimum, capability statements shall include the following:

- Business name and bio, Unique Entity ID (SAM) number, business address, business website, business size status (i.e., SB, VOSB, SDVOSB, HUBZone SB, SDB, WOSB, LB), point of contact name, mailing address (if different from business address), phone number and email address. Provide this same information again if responding to provide a service offered by another firm;
- Past Performance (within the last 3 years) information for the sale of same or substantially similar product/service to include date of sale, description, dollar value, client name, client address, client contact name, client point of contact mailing address (if different from that provided for client), client point of contact phone number, client point of contact email address, and name of the manufacturer (to include SAM Unique Entity Identifier (UEI) and size status) if not the respondent;
- Sufficient descriptive literature, brochures, marketing material, etc. detailing the nature of the consumables the responding firm is regularly engaged in manufacturing or selling, that unequivocally demonstrates that offered products can meet the above requirements;
- If applicable, identification of the firm's GSA Schedule contract(s) by Schedule number and SINS that are applicable to this potential requirement are also requested;

- If applicable, identification of Best in Class (BIC) contract information or other Government-wide or HHS-wide contracts that the required consumables are available under;
- If registered in SAM.gov as a large business, provide whether subcontracting opportunities exist for small business concerns;
- Standard commercial warranty and payment terms;
- **Provide place of product manufacture or** service performance and any other applicable information to enable review and analysis pertaining to the Buy American statute and requirements relating to Made in America in the event a nonavailability waiver request through the MIAO Digital Waiver Portal is required;
- Though this is not a request for quote, informational pricing for the equipment/service would be helpful for market research purposes.

This Notice will be posted on SAM.gov. Interested suppliers shall respond with capability statements submitted ONLY by email on or before 2:00 pm (Central Daylight Time in Jefferson AR) on May 15, 2026, to Tim Walbert at timothy.walbert@fda.hhs.gov. Please reference 75F40126SSN133508 in the Subject line of the e-mail.

Disclaimer and Important Notes

This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or pay for the information provided in response. The Government reserves the right to use information provided by respondents for any purpose deemed necessary and legally appropriate. Any organization responding to this notice should ensure that its response is complete and sufficiently detailed to allow the Government to determine the organization's qualifications to perform the work.

Responses with weblinks will not be opened or viewed.

Responses must demonstrate capability, not merely affirm the respondent's capability (i.e. the response must go beyond the statement that, "XYZ company can provide the instrument, technical support etc.").

Respondents are advised that the Government is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted. After a review of the responses received, a pre-solicitation synopsis or combined synopsis/ solicitation may be published on SAM.gov – Contracting Opportunities. However, responses to this notice will not be considered adequate responses to a solicitation.

Confidentiality and Proprietary Information

No proprietary, classified, confidential, or sensitive information should be included in your response. The Government reserves the right to use any non-proprietary technical information in any resultant solicitation(s).

Additional Notes:

If the stated requirements appear restrictive, please submit comments detailing the concern. Failure to provide information indicating that the listed specifications are too restrictive will be interpreted as confirmation that the specifications are adequate for a competitive environment.